

Freelancer Tracking & Payment System

Use Case Study: Graphic Design Services via WhatsApp Communication

Document Purpose

This scenario document outlines operational workflows, payment models, and data tracking logic for a freelancer management platform. It specifically addresses real-world client interactions through WhatsApp, including upfront advances, partial payments, and monthly retainers.

1. Core Scenario Profile

Freelancer Profile: Graphic Designer handling multiple clients across various social media and branding projects.

Primary Channel: WhatsApp (Inquiries, quotes, proof approvals, payment notifications).

Key Challenge: Clients use diverse payment schedules (advance deposits, installment payments, monthly retainers, or post-completion settlement). Keeping track of individual balances without an automated ledger leads to unpaid work or missed follow-ups.

2. Real-World Client Use Cases

Scenario A: Upfront Deposit + Balance on Delivery (50/50 Split)

- **Client:** Local Restaurant ("Burger Craft")
- **Job Scope:** Menu Design & Banner Printing (\$400 Total)
- **Workflow:**
 1. Designer creates a **Project Record** (\$400 total).
 2. System sends an automated WhatsApp invoice request for a **50% Advance (\$200)**.
 3. Client transfers \$200 and sends a receipt screenshot via WhatsApp.
 4. Designer logs a **Transaction** of \$200. Invoice status automatically changes to **Partially Paid** (\$200 Balance Remaining).
 5. Design work commences. Upon final approval, the remaining \$200 is collected, updating status to **Fully Paid**.

Scenario B: Ongoing Monthly Retainer

- **Client:** E-commerce Store ("Aura Fashion")
- **Job Scope:** 12 Social Media Posts / Month (\$300/month recurring)
- **Workflow:**
 1. System generates a recurring **Monthly Invoice** on the 1st of every month.
 2. Work continues as long as the previous month's invoice is **Fully Paid**.
 3. If unpaid by the 5th, an automated WhatsApp payment reminder is sent.

Scenario C: Flexible Milestone / Multiple Partial Payments

- **Client:** Tech Startup ("Nova Code")
- **Job Scope:** Full Brand Identity Package (\$1,000 Total)
- **Workflow:**
 1. Payment 1: \$300 upfront (Logos phase) → **Balance: \$700**
 2. Payment 2: \$400 mid-project (Brand guidelines phase) → **Balance: \$300**
 3. Payment 3: \$300 final delivery (Asset handoff) → **Balance: \$0**

3. System Ledger Representation

Below is how the backend system tracks these active client accounts simultaneously:

Client Name	Project Title	Billing Type	Agreed Amount	Total Paid	Balance Due	Payment Status
Burger Craft	Menu Design	Fixed (50/50)	\$400.00	\$200.00	\$200.00	Partially Paid
Aura Fashion	March Content	Monthly Retainer	\$300.00	\$300.00	\$0.00	Fully Paid
Nova Code	Brand Identity	Milestone	\$1,000.00	\$700.00	\$300.00	Partially Paid
Apex Gym	Promo Flyer	Pay on Delivery	\$150.00	\$0.00	\$150.00	Unpaid

4. Financial Calculation Engine

To keep money tracking accurate without manual math errors, the system applies these core calculations automatically:

Remaining Balance = Total Agreed Amount – ∑(Recorded Transactions)

Freelancer Payout = ∑(Cleared Transactions) × (1 – Agency Commission Rate)

5. Key Features for WhatsApp Automation

- **WhatsApp Payment Link Generator:** Auto-generate short links to share via chat with pre-filled invoice amounts.
- **Automated Instant Receipts:** Whenever a designer logs a payment, a quick thank-you receipt card is sent directly to the client's WhatsApp.
- **Overdue Payment Triggers:** Gentle automated reminders sent 3 days before and on the due date.
- **Mobile Dashboard for Designers:** Quick view of total sales, collected cash, pending payments, and active project deliverables.

Summary of System Value

By separating **Projects** from individual **Transactions**, this system seamlessly accommodates advance deposits, flexible partial payments, and monthly retainers without losing track of outstanding balances. Integrating directly with WhatsApp keeps the experience effortless for both freelancers and clients.